ODETTE SAYS · FREE EDITION

Odette's *Little Notebook*

Twelve kitchen & home tricks you've seen online — checked, explained, and given an honest verdict.



Odette, in her kitchen

— *Odette*

@ODETTESAYS

FREE · 12 PAGES

A WORD BEFORE WE START

Ma chère,



c'est moi

Every week someone sends me a new “miracle” trick. Peel garlic in five seconds. Clean the microwave with one lemon. Fold a fitted sheet in ten seconds.

Some of them are wonderful. Some are half the truth with a good haircut. And some are, how do you say… nonsense. So I made myself a rule: before I believe it, I check it.

This little notebook is the first page of my kitchen ledger. Twelve tricks, each with what to do, why it works (or doesn't), and the small detail the videos always forget.

Keep it near the stove. Write in the margins. And the next time someone tells you a trick, ask yourself the only question that matters: *is it true?*

Bisous, Odette

P.S. — At the back there is a page for *your* verdict. I want to know what you test.

Odette is a fictional character, brought to life with AI for the Odette Says channel. The tricks are real, and each verdict is based on how the method works and on published food-safety and household guidance. Always follow the manufacturer's instructions for your own appliances and surfaces.

HOW TO READ MY VERDICTS

Three stamps, no maybe.



It works, as promised.
Do it the way I describe and you will get the result the video showed you.



It works — with a condition.
Something real is happening, but not for the reason they say, or only if you add the step they left out.



Don't waste your afternoon.
The promise doesn't hold. When I can, I give you the method that actually does the job.

> THREE HOUSE RULES
>
> 1. Never mix vinegar or lemon with bleach. 2. Test any cleaning trick on a hidden corner first, especially stone, brass and plated finishes. 3. Hot water and steam are hot — let things rest before you reach in.

TRICK 01 · KITCHEN

“Shake garlic between two bowls and it peels itself.”

HALF TRUE

WHAT REALLY HAPPENS

Hard shaking knocks the papery skin loose — but only if the garlic is a little dry, and only if you shake for a good 20 to 30 seconds, not the 3 seconds you see on screen. Very fresh, moist garlic keeps its skin.

HOW I DO IT

Press the whole head with the heel of your hand to separate the cloves. Put them in a jar or between two metal bowls and shake like you mean it. Pick out the naked cloves, shake the stubborn ones again.

> *For one or two cloves, don't bother: press each one flat under the side of a wide blade and the skin slips off.*

TRICK 02 · HOUSE

“White vinegar descales a kettle.”

TRUE

WHY IT WORKS

The white crust is mostly calcium carbonate. The mild acid in vinegar dissolves it — slowly, gently, and for almost nothing.

HOW I DO IT

Fill the kettle halfway with equal parts white vinegar and water. Bring it to the boil, switch off, and leave it one hour. Pour away, rinse well, then boil fresh water twice and throw it out.

> *Open the window — the smell is strong. And look at your kettle's manual: some makers prefer citric acid. It works the same way.*

TRICK 03 · KITCHEN

“Parsley stays fresh for two weeks in the fridge.”

TRUE

WHY IT WORKS

Herbs wilt because they lose water. Treat parsley like a bouquet of flowers and it keeps drinking, so the leaves stay firm far longer than in the plastic bag from the shop.

HOW I DO IT

Trim the ends of the stems. Stand the bunch in a jar with two or three centimetres of water, cover the leaves loosely with a bag, and keep it in the fridge. Change the water every few days.

> *The same works for coriander and dill. Not basil — basil hates the cold. Keep it on the counter, like a little plant.*

TRICK 04 · HOUSE

“You can fold a fitted sheet perfectly in ten seconds.”

FALSE

THE TRUTH

Ten seconds is for the camera, after twenty takes. But a neat, flat fitted sheet is possible for everyone — it takes about a minute.

HOW I DO IT

Hold it inside out by two corners. Tuck each corner into the next, so the four corners sit one inside the other. Lay it flat, fold the round elastic edge in to make a clean rectangle, then fold in thirds.

> *A minute of patience, and your linen cupboard looks like a hotel. That I can promise.*

TRICK 05 · KITCHEN

“Eggs put straight into boiling water peel more easily.”

TRUE

WHY IT WORKS

When an egg starts in cold water, the white sets slowly and sticks to the thin membrane under the shell. Lowered into water that is already boiling, the outside sets fast and lets go cleanly.

HOW I DO IT

Bring the water to a boil first. Lower the eggs in gently with a spoon. About 6 to 7 minutes for a soft yolk, 11 to 12 for hard. Then straight into cold water until cool, and peel.

> *Crack the shell all over on the counter, then start peeling from the wide end, where the little air pocket is.*

TRICK 06 · HOUSE

“A lemon in the microwave cleans it by itself.”

HALF TRUE

WHAT REALLY HAPPENS

It's the steam that does the work, not the lemon. Steam softens the dried splashes so they wipe away. The lemon gives a nice smell — plain water, or water with a spoon of vinegar, cleans just as well.

HOW I DO IT

A microwave-safe bowl of water, the lemon halves inside. Heat 3 to 5 minutes until the window is foggy. Leave the door closed 5 more minutes, then wipe with a cloth.

> *The bowl will be very hot. Take it out with a cloth, and slowly.*

TRICK 07 · KITCHEN

“A cold onion won't make you cry.”

HALF TRUE

WHAT REALLY HAPPENS

Cutting an onion releases a gas that stings the eyes. Cold slows it down, so 20 to 30 minutes in the fridge does help. But it won't stop the tears alone.

HOW I DO IT

Chill the onion, yes — and use a very sharp blade, which crushes fewer cells. Leave the root end for last: that's where most of the stinging part is.

> *Cold, sharp, root last. The three together and I cut a whole kilo with dry eyes.*

TRICK 08 · HOUSE

“Half a lemon removes limescale from the tap.”

TRUE

WHY IT WORKS

Lemon juice is full of citric acid, which dissolves the white crust around the spout — the same chemistry as the vinegar in the kettle.

HOW I DO IT

Push half a lemon onto the spout and hold it there with a small bag and an elastic band. Leave it about an hour, then remove, scrub gently with an old toothbrush and rinse.

> *Not on brass, gold-colour or natural stone — acid can mark them. Test a hidden spot, and never leave it overnight.*

TRICK 09 · KITCHEN

“Add the milk last, little by little, and the sauce has no lumps.”

TRUE

WHY IT WORKS

Lumps come when flour meets too much liquid at once and clumps before it can spread. Cook butter and flour together first, then add milk slowly, and every bit of flour is coated before it thickens.

HOW I DO IT

Melt the butter, stir in the flour, cook one or two minutes. Off the heat, add a small splash of milk and whisk to a smooth paste. Then more, little by little, whisking. Back on the heat until it coats the spoon.

> *The first three splashes are the important ones. After that, you can go faster.*

TRICK 10 · HOUSE

“Baking soda makes a stainless steel sink shine.”

TRUE

WHY IT WORKS

Baking soda is a very soft powder: it scrubs off the dull film and water marks without scratching the steel, as long as you stay gentle.

HOW I DO IT

Wet the sink, sprinkle the soda, and rub with a soft damp sponge — always in the direction of the fine lines in the metal. Rinse well and dry with a cloth.

> *Never a metal scourer. And the drying is the secret — water drops are what make it look dull again.*

TRICK 11 · KITCHEN

“Put a banana next to an avocado and it ripens faster.”

HALF TRUE

WHAT REALLY HAPPENS

Bananas give off a natural gas that tells fruit to ripen. On an open counter, most of it just floats away. Close them in together, and then it really works.

HOW I DO IT

Avocado and a ripe banana in a closed paper bag, at room temperature. Check every day — usually one to two days. Once soft, move the avocado to the fridge to stop it.

> *Paper, not plastic. Plastic traps the humidity and you get a soft brown spot instead of a ripe avocado.*

TRICK 12 · HOUSE

“Store T-shirts standing up, not in a pile.”

TRUE

WHY IT WORKS

In a pile you only see the top one, and pulling one out ruins the rest. Standing up, like files in a drawer, you see every shirt at once and take one without touching the others.

HOW I DO IT

Fold each T-shirt into a long rectangle, then in half or in thirds until it stands on its own. Line them up from front to back in the drawer.

> *You will wear the ones at the bottom again. I found three I had forgotten.*

THE QUICK SHEET

All twelve verdicts, on one page.

✂ CUT & STICK ON THE FRIDGE

01	Garlic shaken between two bowls	HALF TRUE
02	Vinegar to descale the kettle	TRUE
03	Parsley in water, two weeks	TRUE
04	Fitted sheet in ten seconds	FALSE
05	Eggs into already-boiling water	TRUE
06	Lemon steam for the microwave	HALF TRUE
07	Cold onion, no tears	HALF TRUE
08	Half a lemon on the tap	TRUE
09	Milk last, little by little	TRUE
10	Baking soda on stainless steel	TRUE
11	Banana ripens the avocado	HALF TRUE
12	T-shirts filed standing up	TRUE

YOUR TURN

The trick I tested myself

Write it down like I do. Then tell me in the comments — the best ones, I check on camera.

THE TRICK

WHAT I DID

WHAT HAPPENED

THE DETAIL NOBODY MENTIONS

☐ TRUE ☐ HALF TRUE ☐ FALSE

IF YOU LIKED THESE TWELVE

The full notebook is waiting.

These are the first pages of my kitchen ledger. The complete edition goes much further — every trick with the same care: the verdict, the reason, the method, and the small detail that changes everything.

VOLUME I

The Kitchen Verdicts

Food storage, eggs, sauces, bread, fruit and vegetables — the tricks that save food and money.

VOLUME II

The House Verdicts

Limescale, laundry, stains, wood, steel and glass — what really cleans, and what only smells nice.

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TikTok · Instagram · YouTube — two new verdicts every day

Odette is a fictional character created with AI. The information in this notebook is general household guidance, not professional advice. Check your appliance and surface manufacturer's instructions, test cleaning methods on a hidden area, and never combine acids (vinegar, lemon) with bleach. © Odette Says.